happen each and every time, thorough preparation and training along with the highest quality of leadership is called for.

Is one a born leader or are leaders made? This question has engaged military researchers since ages. In my view, barring an odd historical example, leaders are made. But in the same breath, I would like to add that a good leader must also have certain attributes that are inherited or come with the genes. A mule will remain a mule no matter how much training or hard work is put in. To be an effective leader one has to have an above-average intellect and be physically and mentally robust. Despite the revolution in military affairs, a good leader has to lead by example and from the front. Things haven't changed much from the days of Alexander or Hannibal in so far as setting a personal example and sharing the hardships and risks are concerned. 'Many have often seen Hannibal lying on the ground wrapped only in a military cloak amid the sentries and outposts of his soldiers,' wrote the Roman historian Livy. The relationship between the leader and the led will always remain an important factor, and a well-trained, -equipped and -led soldier will be the final determinant of success in war.

Ours is a command-oriented army. We have seen five wars in our six decades of history as an independent nation. The Indian Army is, therefore, a battle-hardened and combat-tested army. 'The million-man army actually fights, unlike the post-modern militaries of many of our European allies,' as stated by US Ambassador Robert Blackwill in the summer of 2005. India's hardwon victory in Kargil and successful prosecution of the campaign against jehadis in Kashmir would have been in his mind when he made those remarks. However, the last major war we fought was forty years ago. Unfortunately, today in our army there are very few veterans around with such war experience. There are not many officers and men who might have seen a bullet being fired in anger, other than those who have served in Jammu and Kashmir or the northeast, or a localized war such as the one we fought in the Kargil region during the summer of 1999. However, keeping in view our unresolved border issues with China and Pakistan and other national security challenges, we have to be 'ready and relevant' to defend our